unauthorised person and it is made clear that those working on cypher jobs will never be released from their charter of secrecy even when they are no longer employed on cypher duties, don't have access to the cyphers or aren't with the service any longer. During their training, those coding messages are forbidden to discuss cypher matters even amongst

themselves in any place where they are likely to be overheard by potential eavesdroppers. The identity of personnel handling cyphers is kept top secret and only a handful of top officers posted abroad know about their activities.

During the fledgling years of the R&AW, certain rules were formulated to keep the coding of information safe and secure. For instance, cypher officers have separate accommodation, which have to meet certain conditions:

(i) It does not in any way form a passage to another room or office, which is not used for cyphers.

(ii) Windows, skylights, etc. should be of translucent material, barred and protected by wire mesh to prevent papers from blowing away.

(iii) Doors should be strong and fitted with a secure locking arrangement.

(iv) Walls and ceiling should not be made of canvas or light boards.

(v) Persons walking or standing outside should not be able to hear or see what is being said or done inside.

(vi) All cypher material will be kept in a locked, heavy combination safe or in a security box permanently